and strength to accommodate the number and weight of the wet clothes. To avoid rust-staining of clothes, clips of plastic or aluminium are widely used, but these must have strong holding capacity.

5.3.6.1 Indoor Drying Aids

Several drying aids are particularly developed and are in use for indoor area, like flats and also when it is raining. One of these is a "wooden rack with rope and pulley" arrangement. The wooden rack has many horizontal wooden bars on which the wet clothes are spread. Therefore, it is pulled to the roof level with the help of a rope passing over a pulley fixed to roof.

In additional, many types of folding racks are used for drying purpose. A rack consists of a three-legged iron stand with a central vertical rod projective upward. To a disc attached at the top end of the vertical rod. The clothes are spread on these horizontal rods and the racks positioned at a cross-ventilating place till they are dried. The folding race can be folded with a straight bar shape for accommodation in a corner of the room. Many horizontal bars can also be fitted to the wall at a ventilated place, one above the other, for drying of clothes. Similarly, these may be fixed to a vertical stand, at different heights. These racks can be of wood, aluminium or a chrome plated metal and may take any shape available for drying.

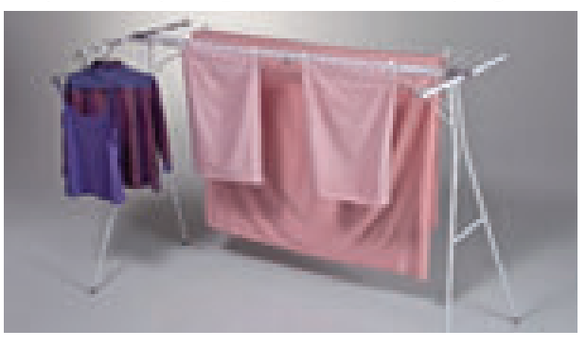


Figure 5.18 Indoor Drying Aids

5.4 Ironing Equipments

These are used to remove wrinkles and to give a better finish to the washed clothing's. Ironing clothes is really a delicate process. Poor ironing procedure leads to damaged clothing.



Figure 5.19 Iron Box

5.4.1 Irons

Iron is also known as 'flat iron', it is used to remove wrinkles in the fabrics. Several types are available, such as dry iron, steam and dry iron, spray-steam and dry iron. The dry irons are useful for synthetic fabrics, but to use the same the natural fabrics require pre-dampening by sprinkling of water. This wastes both time and energy of the user. Steam and dry irons have a water chamber in which a small quantity of water is heated to provide a continuous generation of steam through holes in the soles-plate. 'Spray, steam and dry' models also have one extra control to supply a wet spray or mist at the front of the iron.

The sole plate is smooth and made of rust-resistant aluminium alloys or stainless or chrome-plated steel. The heating units of irons have a single element mounted above or in the sole plate. This is either a nichrome ribbon wrapped around mica sheets or a tubular type element. Standard size domestic irons are rated between 750 to 1200 watts, 220 volts AC only. These are thermostatically controlled to give different

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